Proponent's Argument

YES ON I: KEEP THE PROMISE. AFFORDABLE HOUSING WITH NO NEW TAXES.

San Francisco's housing crisis is pushing families, seniors, teachers, nurses, artists, immigrants, and young people out of the city they love.

In 2020, voters approved a tax on the sale of properties worth more than $10 million, specifically so that money could fund affordable housing and rent relief.

It worked until politicians ignored the will of voters. This tax on San Francisco's wealthiest property owners provided emergency rent relief to more than 10,000 households and helped preserve and build hundreds of affordable homes.

But it wasn't guaranteed. In the **past two years, none of this revenue has gone to affordable housing**.

Prop I will finally keep the promise and implement the measure voters approved.

- **Doesn't raise taxes** -- uses only revenue from a tax voters already approved.
- **Cuts the transfer tax for new housing construction,** so we keep building the homes we need.
- **Independent oversight** -- mandatory annual audits by the City Controller, filed publicly.
- **The only measure on the ballot** that guarantees both innovative social housing and ongoing rental assistance.

This November, San Franciscans have a historic opportunity: two measures on the ballot that guarantee affordable housing funding without raising anyone's taxes.

Vote YES on Prop I to guarantee this funding finally does what voters intended.

Read more: YesonISF.com

Affordable Housing Alliance
San Francisco Tenants Union
Small Business Forward
United Educators of San Francisco
Service Employees International Union SEIU 1021
Council of Community Housing Coalitions
Faith in Action Bay Area
Senior and Disability Action
Anti Displacement Coalition
Community Tenants Association
Housing Rights Committee
Tenants Together
Democratic Socialist of America - San Francisco
San Franciscans for Social Housing

Rebuttal to Proponent's Argument

DON'T BE FOOLED: PROP I CREATES A NONPROFIT SLUSH FUND AND DOESN'T GUARANTEE NEW HOUSING

Prop I's proponents say this measure "keeps the promise" of affordable housing without raising taxes. That is not what Prop I does.

Prop I would lock roughly $120 million a year away from the General Fund without requiring that a single new unit of housing be built.

30% must go to "social housing." Another 25% can go to nonprofits to buy existing apartments. Another 10% can fund nonprofit programs that do not build new homes. Five percent can go to administration.

That means at least 70% of the money does not have to build housing.

Audits do not fix Prop I's fundamental flaw. It can be perfectly audited and still spend most of its money without building a single new home. A transfer-tax cut does not change that. How much new housing does Prop I require? None.

The budget damage goes further. Pulling $120 million out of the General Fund shrinks funding baselines, including Muni's. Amid a Muni funding crisis, Prop I would drastically cut transit funding while reducing resources for firefighters, public safety, clean streets, and other essential services.

The San Francisco Building and Construction Trades Council represents workers who actually build housing. We support affordable housing, not a measure that promises housing without guaranteeing new homes.

Vote NO on Prop I.

San Francisco Building and Construction Trades Council

Arguments are the opinions of the authors and have not been checked for accuracy by any official agency.
Arguments are printed as submitted. Spelling and grammatical errors have not been corrected.

Opponent's Argument

Vote NO on the Affordable Housing Guarantee Act.

While affordable housing is an important priority, locking transfer tax revenues into rigid set-asides is fiscal mismanagement that threatens San Francisco's financial stability.

1. Creates Dangerous Budget Earmarks
San Francisco's General Fund pays for vital everyday services—including police officers, firefighters, 911 dispatchers, street cleaning, and public parks. Carving out transfer tax revenues into a restricted fund starves the General Fund of essential dollars, forcing severe service cuts across the city during lean budget years.

2. Relies on Highly Volatile Revenue
Real estate transfer taxes are notoriously unpredictable. Basing housing commitments on real estate sales creates an unstable funding cycle that collapses whenever property values or commercial transactions drop. Managing long-term programs on volatile tax revenues is fiscally reckless.

3. Deepens Downtown Economic Stagnation
San Francisco's commercial real estate market is already struggling with historically high vacancy rates. Increasing burden or restricting tax policy on high-value properties discourages investment, depresses property values, and weakens our overall tax base—ultimately reducing total revenue available for public services.

4. Reduces Flexibility and Oversight
City leaders need the flexibility to adapt to economic downturns and emerging local emergencies. Tying revenue up in permanent structural mandates removes budget oversight and prevents the City from reallocating resources where they are needed most.

Protect core city services and financial stability.

Vote NO on Measure I.

Judge Quentin L Kopp
San Francisco Taxpayers Association

Rebuttal to Opponent's Argument

YES ON I — AFFORDABLE HOUSING. NO NEW TAXES.

Opponents call affordable housing "an important priority." They're right. But they oppose Prop I, which builds affordable housing *without raising taxes*. That's plain wrong.

San Francisco's state-mandated housing plan calls for 46,000 affordable homes to be built by 2031. Prop I is a step forward. It will create thousands of affordable homes without costing taxpayers a dime.

Prop I keeps a promise made to voters in 2020 which city hall politicians have ignored. It requires the city to use an existing tax on sales of properties valued at ten million dollars or more to fund affordable housing.

For the first few years, politicians kept the promise. But over the last two years, not one dollar of this revenue has gone to housing.

Prop I is accountable:

- **Every dollar in Prop I will be managed** by the Mayor's Office of Housing
- **Mandatory annual audits** will be conducted by the City Controller
- **Taxes on new housing are reduced to encourage growth**
- **And it won't raise taxes!**

Our housing crisis demands innovative solutions, not tired opposition from people who have opposed affordable housing for decades. Join us and Vote Yes on I.

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